

22 Rules of Engagement

Adapted from slides by Simon Lock and Daniel Schien

Why 22 rules?

- For many students, this is a first encounter with a “business” culture
- The clients are volunteering to work with you, and can be as shy and uncertain as you are
- We need to interact professionally and be mindful of their time and knowledge

Email

1. All emails to the client are sent by the client liaison (unless they are ill or otherwise unable to)
2. The client liaison copies in all team members and the mentor on every email to the client
3. All email addresses included in a received email are included in all replies
4. If the client removes email addresses from their organisation, they are NOT added back in replies
5. If the client removes email addresses from the team or mentor, add them back in why you reply
6. Unless you have a good reason not to, an email starts “Dear <client first name>”
7. Unless you have a good reason not to, an email ends with “All the best/<client liaison first name>”

How NOT to communicate with your client

8. Do not ask them anything related to the marking or the organisation of the unit – ask this in the [Unit Team Q&A channel](#).
9. Try to minimise communication with the client (batch requests into a 'weekly' email if appropriate)
10. If you are unsure if you should be sharing something with your client, ask your mentor
11. Don't expect the client to do work for you – if there is a task that you can do yourselves, you are expected to do it (e.g. researching something, looking things up on their organisation website)

Meetings

12. When you arrange meetings with your client, calendar invites are sent out with Teams calls – unless the client explicitly says they would like to invite you
13. Meetings ALWAYS start on time and are aimed to finish 10 minutes early
14. NEVER over-run a meeting without explicitly confirming that this is OK with everyone, especially the client
15. If you're on video calls, all students have cameras turned on unless there is an exceptional, strong reason not to
16. All team members participate in every meeting, unless you have an exceptional, strong reason for a single occasion
17. Send out an agenda before the meeting. This can be part of the calendar invite, or in a separate email the day before.
18. One student takes notes as minutes, and these are shared with the client after the meeting. Notes are action-focused, not a narrative description of everything that was said

Attitudes

19. Assume that the client does not know anything, except what they would like the software to do.

In particular, the client does not know anything about the project run time, the Teaching Block, what frameworks to use, where and how to deploy software etc.

20. Your job is to act as a filter and buffer between the client and the unit – only pass on information and requests that the client actually needs to know (don't just forward our messages/slides/web pages to them)

21. In every meeting, attempt to understand the other side and what they value, and find a solution that maximises value for both sides

22. Be professional and present a united front! If you disagree with each other in the team, don't let the client know